

ate debts. The results were beyond our imaginations as other churches and Sunday School classes took up the challenge. Within two weeks, our group, along with John and Paula's church, had raised over \$40,000 and all the bills were paid—in full. God had honored their commitment to trust Him and taught us a lesson as well: God had already provided what they needed, through us.

### SOME ARE CHEAP

Not every couple is going to have debt problems. About 10 percent of our population are basically so cheap (or frugal) that they're never going to get into debt. I will never knowingly get into debt. There's some control system inside me that keeps me from overspending. I can't stand to pay interest and I can't stand to owe anyone, so if I borrow, it's short-term and very limited.

### SOME ARE SLOPPY

Another 10 percent of our population make enough money to be sloppy and get away with it. They feel they can live without a budget, because if they should get into financial trouble, they can simply cut back on their indulgences for a while and pay their way out of it. Very few young couples fit into this category. Usually these "sloppies" are the attorneys, dentists, and doctors among us. Most doctors, for instance, make far more than the national average, so you might think they don't have financial problems. That's not true. They're the classic example that it's not what you make that's important, but how much you spend.

I was working in my office one afternoon when an attorney friend called to ask for some counsel. It seems that a client of his, a doctor, had been served notice by the IRS that his property was being attached (legally taken over) for failure to pay taxes. In fact, this doctor had arrived home one evening to find an IRS agent there impounding his cars, home, and furnishings. He rushed to the attorney's office, and the attorney then called me. Sadly, this was not the first such episode of